



BJP MP Ravi Shankar Prasad, a former Union minister of Law, Communications and IT, began the day by emphasising that crypto and blockchain are not the same: “We have never been against blockchain; in fact we encouraged blockchain technology, I think it will be and should be encouraged.” On crypto assets, he said the government is still consulting various stakeholders, and momentum would pick up very soon.

Next, former chief economic advisor Krishnamurthy Subramanian pointed out that it is unlikely that the central bank digital currency (CBDC) will be a large part of the broad money (bank money or deposits) in the economy. Instead, CBDC will be part of the narrow money (existing physical currency). “We have to be very careful because when you are talking about monetary policy, we are actually talking about the

1. Aroon Purie,
Chairman and Editor-in-Chief of the India Today Group, with Rajeev Chandrasekhar

2. (From left) Rahul Kanwal, ED, Business Today and News Director, TV Today Network; BJP MP Jayant Sinha; Shiv Sena MP Priyanka Chaturvedi; BJD MP Pinaki Misra; and former Congress MP Rajeev Gowda

3. Krishnamurthy Subramanian, former chief economic advisor

broad money. Broad money is created when banks give out loans,” said Subramanian, now a professor at the Indian School of Business.

The event then moved to one of the most exciting themes of digital assets—NFTs or non-fungible tokens. A wide range of celebrities are minting NFTs to engage with their fans and make good money. The panellists, however, felt that much more can be done. “In India, 25 per cent of the Supreme Court cases and 66 per cent of all civil cases are of land disputes. Imagine if all the land records would be minted as NFTs. A lot of the court’s time would be saved,” said Kashif Raza, Founder of Bitinning.

The NFT session was followed by an intense debate on blockchain and crypto. The discussion moved from the promise of Web 3.0 to a parallel financial system created by crypto to much more. A key point discussed